



Figure 5: Settings page

```
$page_content .= l($links->title, 'node/' . $links->nid)
. '<br />';
}
return $page_content;
}
```

Creating a Settings page for the module

Here's the code for it:

```
function recentblogs_admin() {
  $form = array();
  $form['recentblogs_maxdisp'] = array(
    'type' => 'textfield',
    '#title' => t('Maximum number of links'),
    '#default_value' => variable_get('recentblogs_maxdisp',
3),
    '#size' => 2,
    '#maxlength' => 2,
    '#description' => t('The maximum number of links to
display in the block.'),
    '#required' => TRUE,
  );
  return system_settings_form($form);
}
```

The function code is self-explanatory. The resultant page looks like what's shown in Figure 5.

Create menu links to the Settings and main pages

The piece of code below creates the menu links. Observe the page argument 'recentblogs_admin'; this will let Drupal know that settings are defined using the function 'recentblogs_admin'. The creation of a form with buttons is done using the call 'page callback' => 'drupal_get_form'.

```
function recentblogs_menu() {
  $items = array();

  $items['admin/settings/recentblogs'] = array(
    'title' => 'recentblogs module settings',
```

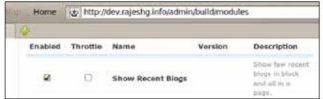


Figure 6: Listing the module

```
'description' => 'settings page - recentblogs',
'page callback' => 'drupal_get_form',
'page arguments' => array('recentblogs_admin'),
'access arguments' => array('access administration pages'),
'type' => MENU_NORMAL_ITEM,
);
$items['recentblogs'] = array(
'title' => 'Created Recently',
'page callback' => 'recentblogs_all',
'access arguments' => array('access recentblogs content'),
'type' => MENU_CALLBACK
);
return $items;
}
```

The *\$items['recentblogs']* provides the link to the main page.

Let Drupal know about the module

In order for Drupal to list this module, create a 'recentblogs.info' file with the following content, in *module_dir*:

```
name = Show Recent Blogs
description = Show few recent blogs in block and all in a page.
core = 6.x
package = "Testing"
```

The *package* field is used to group this module. When this file is saved, your module will appear in the list, as shown in Figure 6. You can enable the module by ticking the 'Enabled' check box. Once you enable the module and save its configuration, you can see the module block in the list of blocks at <your site name>/admin/build/block/list. **END** 

References

- 1) <http://www.ibm.com/developerworks/ibm/osource/Implement.html>
- 2) <http://drupal.org/node/206753>

By: Rajesh Gheware

The author has been playing with (FOSS) since he first came across LFY in 2009. He is passionate about using technology to make life simple. In his free time he loves to read, travel and experiment with new gadgets and technology. His latest passion is - building cost effective road navigation using GPS for Netbook - <http://gpsfornetbook.in>